

being forced to withdraw when their exposed flank was caught in enfilading fire—sweeping the length of their line. Even then Union forces were unable to break through; two entire corps that could have been committed to the sector were standing idle across the creek.

McClellan's original battle plan had envisaged Major General Ambrose Burnside distracting the Confederate right, while the main Union attack went in on the left. But Burnside did not move until 10 a.m. and then chose to feed his divisions across the Lower Bridge, which would later come to bear his name. On the Confederate side, Burnside's Bridge was covered by the fire of Georgian sharpshooters and artillery under the command of Brigadier General Robert Toombs. Union forces took three hours to fight their way across and even then could not exploit their success.

■ 38,000 **The number of Confederate troops eventually engaged at Antietam. Lee had started his invasion of Maryland two weeks before with an army of 55,000.**